

Olwen — internal mobility for large employers

The Problem

A company of 8,000 people runs two parallel processes that never meet. Recruiters spend €18,000 and eleven weeks filling a role externally. Meanwhile someone three floors away has the skills, wants the move, and will leave within the year because nobody told them the role existed.

Internal mobility is everyone's stated priority and nobody's system. The tooling that exists is a job board bolted onto the HR platform, and employees do not look at it.

Our Solution

Olwen matches open roles to internal candidates and tells them, rather than waiting for them to look.

We build a skills profile from what people actually do — project systems, internal documentation, past roles — rather than from a form they were asked to fill in once. When a role opens, the ten best internal matches get a message explaining why they were matched and what the gap is.

Managers see who in their team is a flight risk and what would keep them. That view is what gets the product adopted, and it is also the part people find uncomfortable, so we made it opt-in per employee.

The Market

HR technology is a \$38B market. Internal mobility and talent marketplace tooling is a recognised segment within it, worth roughly \$2.4B and growing.

We sell to companies above 3,000 employees, where the arithmetic of internal versus external hiring becomes impossible to ignore.

Competition

The large HR suites all offer an internal marketplace module. Three independent vendors compete directly with us, and honestly our products look similar in a demo. The category has converged on the same feature set.

What we have is distribution rather than differentiation: partnerships with two major HR platforms that surface us inside tools employees already use. That is why we get adopted where standalone competitors do not.

The Team

Naledi Mokoena led talent operations at a European retail group of 30,000 employees, where internal mobility was her mandate and her frustration. Tom Halvorsen built the matching infrastructure at a recruitment marketplace.

Nineteen people, and both partnerships were sourced by the founders directly.

Traction

- 41 enterprise customers covering 310,000 employees
- 94,000 employees with an active profile
- 3,100 internal moves attributed to the platform in twelve months
- customers report an average external hiring cost avoided of €14,000 per internal move
- two HR platform partnerships, representing 60% of new customers

Business Model

Per-employee-per-year pricing at €9, with volume tiers. Annual recurring revenue is €2.1M.

The model has a problem we have not solved. Our pricing is per employee, but our value is per internal move, and those are not correlated: a customer with 20,000 employees and low turnover pays the most and gets the least. Three renewals have been renegotiated downward on exactly this argument.

We are testing an outcome-linked structure with two customers. It is too early to say whether it holds.

Go-To-Market

Mostly through the two platform partnerships, which bring qualified pipeline at low cost. Direct sales exist but convert poorly against incumbent suite modules that are already paid for.

The partnership dependency is real: either partner could build this, and one has begun hiring for it.

Funding

We are raising €8M to resolve the pricing model, build a direct sales motion that does not depend on partners, and deepen the skills inference that is currently our only defensible asset.